

Impact High · Difficulty Easy-Medium · Misuse risk It fails when you over-label, overstate, diagnose, or sound like you are inte

THE MOVE

Tentative cue + emotion or concern + optional reason, then pause. -> It sounds like this felt pretty unfair. -> I might be off, but part of this sounds disappointing. -> Not just stressful - more like exhausting? -> There seems to be a fairness piece ?

START HERE

Offer one tentative label - 'That sounds [emotion]' or just '[emotion]?' - in a soft tone, then stop talking.

SAY THIS

Quick labels	<i>"That sounds frustrating."</i>
Soft / tentative	<i>"I might be reading this wrong, but it sounds like..."</i>
Two-emotion labels	<i>"Exciting and unsettling?"</i>
Warm / connecting	<i>"That sounds like it hit harder than expected."</i>
Professional	<i>"It sounds like the main frustration is uncertainty."</i>
Conflict-softening	<i>"It sounds like that felt unfair."</i>

AVOID

- You are guessing too confidently, or using the label as a tactic to steer them.
- The person dislikes being analysed, or is already feeling exposed.
- The label would embarrass them in front of others.

REMEMBER

Go one shade softer.